Lecture Notes

Six steps to active listening
(May 19th, 2025; Parts from Stanford Report)

- 1. Pay full attention: To show you are paying attention, nonverbal cues matter. Some of the ways people can demonstrate they are engaged include nodding, maintaining eye contact, and removing distractions.
- 2. Suspend judgment: Judgment is about imposing meaning and preconceived beliefs onto a situation.
- 3. Pause and reflect: Reflecting can be particularly challenging when facing ideas antithetical to one's own. However, this is precisely when reflection can be most transformative for communication.
- 4. Ask clarifying questions: Clarifying is critical. Even if you think you've understood, this is your chance to gain further understanding.
- 5. Summarize: This tells the other person that you understood both what they said and the intention behind it. This is not only to give your own conclusion or views but rather try to faithfully describe the essence of what the other person has been trying to say and to summarize it in a way that they would say. It fosters connection and trust.
- 6. Share: This is the final step. After you've confirmed that you've correctly understood what your conversation partner has said, it's your turn. This builds relationships.

Good reflecting: paraphrasing

- Sums up what the other person has said, making it clearer and more real.
- Checks out that you have understood and interpreted the meaning correctly.
- Reassures the speaker that they are being heard.
- Communicates acceptance, respect, and concern.
- Is non-judgmental.
- Avoid both aggressive and submissive behavior.
- Use of humor and information correctly.

Body Language and Public Presentations

- Avoid lax, closed, judgmental postures
- Avoid critical/mocking facial expressions
- Stay relaxed: focus on your work at hand; not the hands and feet
- Sit/stand upright but comfortably

- Make eye contact with the audience
- Be receptive of people's reactions; be welcoming by extending an arm or smiling
- Be humble and sincere; express gratitude and respect

The Rogerian Strategy

- Rogerian argumentation is not a step-by-step method but a general strategy. Its goal is to create an atmosphere in which meaningful negotiations can take place.
- Can be non-negotiable if parties are at loggerheads and believe in absolute opposites. Or lead to non-optimal compromises.

PRINCIPLED NEGOTIATION

- Separate the people from the problem
- Focus on interests, not positions
- Invent options for mutual gain
- Insist on using objective criteria

Designing the Resume

- Summary of all your activities and experience
- Repeats some/most of information in the letter of application
- Highlights your most important qualifications
- Command of other languages
- Technical/Software expertise
- Date on which you can start working
- Availability of references

References

- Make connections and contacts in advance
- They should have a fair and positive idea of your work and credentials
- Make sure to avoid a conflict of interest
- Either available on request or list your referees
- Better take her/his/their permission

Meetings: Dos and Don'ts

1. Give yourself adequate time to prepare for it

2. Decide who you want to invite to the meeting
3.Include only those who will contribute to it
4.Do not include those who are likely to pursue their own agendas and disrupt yours
5. Do not include those who have nothing to say
6. Write up an agenda and send it to all participants
7. Tell them what you hope to accomplish
8. This will heighten the participant's expectations
9. Encourage them to think about the topics beforehand and organize their thoughts
10. Increase the chances of there being a clear focus and a clear outcome
11. Minutes of Meetings are crucial for later reporting and action